CONFIDENTIAL.

British Consulate,
Tamsui,
Formosa.

1298/3.1/52.

30th June, 1952.

(Dear Chancery),

F 1103101 87

We have been puzzled by recent conflicting reports in the local press as to the Japanese Government's attitude towards the Nationalist Chinese Government's claim to sovereignty over the whole of China. We particularly have in mind the following reports:-

On 11th June in the Diet, Okazaki stated that the parties signing the Sino-Japanese bilateral treaty took completely different stands as to the sovereignty question, Nationalist China signing as the legal government of China, whilst Japan recognised Nationalist China's power as being limited to Formosa.

On 18th June Wajima, in an explanation to the Foreign Affairs Committee of the Diet, inferred that the Japanese government recognised the National Government as the legal government of China, and that the state of war between China and Japan was ended by the treaty of 28th April.

On 21st June Masuda, a spokesman of the Foreign Office Information Section, stated that Japan had not recognised the sovereignty of the Nationalist Government over the whole of China.

On 24th June Kakitsubo, head of the Foreign Office Information Section, stated at a press conference that the Japanese Government regard the Nationalist Government as the legal government of China and that the attitude of Japan was substantially the same as that of America.

2. We have talked over this matter with Kimura, the head of the Japanese Overseas Agency in Taipei, who disclaims having received any instructions from his government. He expressed surprise, however, that the Japanese Government should openly declare its recognition of Nationalist China's sovereignty over the whole of China, and repeated what he had told us earlier, that the peace delegation's instructions had been to steer clear of this delicate subject, and so far as possible, resist the inclusion of specific references to sovereignty in the treaty.

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Chancery,
British Embassy,
Tokyo.

Copied to:-

China and Korea Department,
Foreign Office,
London, S.W.1.

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3. It seems to us, therefore, that it is quite likely that there has been no fundamental change in the cautious attitude which the Japanese have throughout preserved towards the Chinese sovereignty issue. We are, however, unable to check the accuracy of the reports as transmitted, and suspect that they may have been distorted by newsmen having an axe to grind. On the other hand, they may be unguarded statements by persons who have not fully considered the implications of their words.

4. We should, therefore, be very interested to have your views on this matter, and in particular, we should value your opinion as to what the official Japanese Government attitude is towards the Chinese sovereignty question.

5. Since writing the above, we have seen in a press report that on 27th June, Yoshida, before the Upper House Foreign Affairs Committee, stated that Japan did not recognise the National Government in Taiwan as the sovereign government of the whole of China. This pronouncement from a more authoritative source seems to confirm our opinion that there has been no substantial change in the Japanese Government's attitude, since the signing of the bilateral treaty.

6. We should, however, still be grateful for your comments.

(Yours ever),

(E.H. Jacobs-Larkcom)
Consul.

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